ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 1

Chapter 9: **The Proposal (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(d)** formal purpose and petty behaviour	Dignity versus pettiness.
2	**(d)** comic effect	Exaggeration.
3	**(b)** Never had Lomov felt so nervous.	Inversion after 'never'.
4	**(d)** single setting, small cast, unity of action	Compactness.
5	**(c)** Characters quarrel over meadows and dogs when love is at stake	Pettiness.
6	**(a)** had not criticised	Third conditional.
7	**(c)** the audience guesses Lomov's purpose before Natalya does	The audience knows more.
8	**(b)** talk of land at the proposal scene	Property focus.
9	**(b)** a relative clause	Adjective clause.
10	**(d)** it drives the plot but is overshadowed by quarrels	Plot driver.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Delay creates comic tension (1) and lets the quarrels reveal character (1).	1+1
12	The audience senses Lomov's purpose (1) while Chubukov and Natalya do not yet (1).	1+1
13	As the cause of absurd conflict (1) which hides true feelings (1).	1+1
14	It focuses attention on dialogue (1) and intensifies the sense of an argument trapped in one space (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Two quarrels drive the plot (1). They reveal temperaments (1). The resolution comes only after exhaustion (1).	1+1+1
16	Land could become a property dispute online (1). Dogs could be replaced by gadgets or social media rivalry (1). The theme of ego stays the same (1).	1+1+1
17	Chubukov said to Lomov, 'Why are you dressed so formally?' (1). Quotation marks and question mark (1). Tense returns to present (1).	1+1+1
	OR: They indicate gestures like faints and shouts (1). They control pace (1). They add physical humour (1).	1+1+1
18	It traps characters (1). It forces confrontation (1). It exposes their pettiness (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Although Lomov was nervous, he wanted to propose (1). Unless he stayed calm, he would faint (1). Both are complex sentences (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Characters reflect real traits (1). Quarrels show pettiness (1). Property and marriage satirised (1). Laughter invites reflection (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Aim (1). Characterisation (1). Staging (1). Tempo and humour (1). Message (1).	2+2+1
20	Theme (1). Characters (1). Dialogue (1). Humour (1). Overall judgement (1).	2+2+1
	OR: He welcomes Lomov (1). He fuels the quarrels (1). He panics (1). He forces the engagement (1). He is the comic engine (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lomov is a poor man; he is a **landowning neighbour** who comes to propose to Natalya Stepanovna but is soon distracted.
- Mixing up the quarrels: first **Oxen Meadows**, then the dogs **Guess** (Lomov's) and **Squeezer** (Chubukov's).
- Giving the cause of Lomov's collapse as illness only; his **nerves and palpitations** worsen with each argument, a source of comic effect.
- Calling the play a tragedy; it is a **farce** by Anton Chekhov, with humour from exaggerated quarrels and the ironic title.

- Saying Natalya refused him; she **wanted** to marry and cried out to bring him back as soon as she learnt his purpose.
- Describing *Chubukov* as calm and wise; he is a hot-tempered father who also wants a rich son-in-law.

Evaluator's note: Award step marks as shown; accept any correct alternative method. In internal-choice questions, evaluate only the option attempted. Deduct up to ½ mark for missing units or figures where required.

MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 2

Chapter 9: **The Proposal (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(a)** marriage of convenience	Marriage and property.
2	**(b)** ending a quarrel	Make peace.
3	**(b)** emotional insecurity	Nerves.
4	**(a)** dialogue and action	Dramatic dialogue.
5	**(b)** Quarrelling ruined the proposal.	'Quarrelling' functions as noun.
6	**(d)** stichomythia-like banter	Short rapid lines.
7	**(d)** a proposal of marriage ending in a quarrel	Opposites.
8	**(b)** rapid pace	Speed.
9	**(b)** anger gives way to engagement instantly	Sudden change.
10	**(c)** amused but sympathetic	Gentle satire.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Formal clothes and polite speech are undone (1) by quarrels over land and dogs (1).	1+1
12	A proposal suggests romance (1) but the play shows the arguments around it (1).	1+1
13	It makes him ridiculous (1) and each ailment appears at moments of stress (1).	1+1
14	It shows pride extending to pets (1) and escalates the personal insults (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	Lomov uses cautious, fussy phrases (1). Natalya is quick and sharp (1). Chubukov is loud and hearty (1).	1+1+1
16	It restores energy (1). It shows incomplete change (1). It leaves audiences smiling (1).	1+1+1
17	Cheerful and loud (1). It turns the scene to celebration (1). It also makes the end comic (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Marriage is tied to property (1). Courtship is overshadowed by quarrels (1). Yet the end is happy, so the satire is gentle (1).	1+1+1
18	Chubukov misreads Lomov's purpose (1). Lomov and Natalya misread each other (1). Resulting chaos creates humour (1).	1+1+1
	OR: Use loud voices and exaggerated gestures (1). Add comic business like pointing at imaginary dogs (1). Increase tempo (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	One set (1). Small cast (1). Fast dialogue (1). Physical comedy (1). Clear structure (1).	2+2+1
	OR: They reach an engagement (1). They remain quarrelsome (1). Little self-knowledge (1). Satire of unchanging human nature (1). Judgement (1).	2+2+1
20	Setting (1). Characters (1). Trivial quarrel (1). Comic climax (1). Resolution (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Headline (1). Intro (1). Details (1). Quotes (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lomov is a poor man; he is a **landowning neighbour** who comes to propose to Natalya Stepanovna but is soon distracted.
- Mixing up the quarrels: first **Oxen Meadows**, then the dogs **Guess** (Lomov's) and **Squeezer** (Chubukov's).
- Giving the cause of Lomov's collapse as illness only; his **nerves and palpitations** worsen with each argument, a source of comic effect.
- Calling the play a tragedy; it is a **farce** by Anton Chekhov, with humour from exaggerated quarrels and the ironic title.
- Saying Natalya refused him; she **wanted** to marry and cried out to bring him back as soon as she learnt his purpose.
- Describing *Chubukov* as calm and wise; he is a hot-tempered father who also wants a rich son-in-law.

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MASTERMIND

ANSWER KEY & MARKING SCHEME SET 3

Chapter 9: **The Proposal (First Flight)** | Class 10 English | Maximum Marks: 40

SECTION — A (Objective Type) — Answers — 10 × 1 = 10

Q.	Correct Option	Brief Reasoning
1	**(b)** The characters are types rather than complex individuals	Farce uses types.
2	**(d)** obsessed with possessions and pride	Satire.
3	**(d)** the three-way dynamic	A focused cast.
4	**(c)** recognisable human weakness	Universal human traits.
5	**(a)** a landowning class's concerns	Context.
6	**(c)** quick tempo and exaggerated gestures	Stage business.
7	**(d)** continuing without pause	Non-stop.
8	**(a)** nervous energy and sudden outbursts	To suit the comedy.
9	**(d)** arguing over trivial things	Petty argument.
10	**(d)** realistic, serious tone	Farce is not serious.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 2 = 8

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
11	Its humour is universal (1) and its setting simple to stage (1).	1+1
12	He overreacts to a simple faint (1) and his change from rage to grief is sudden (1).	1+1
13	Celebration despite chaos (1) and the characters' return to normal (1).	1+1
14	They represent traits like pride and anxiety (1) which suits farce but limits depth (1).	1+1

SECTION — C (Short Answer) — Answers — 4 × 3 = 12

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
15	His ailments evoke sympathy (1). His outbursts evoke laughter (1). Together they make him a rounded type (1).	1+1+1
16	Headline: Proposal Ends in Faint at Chubukov's House (1). Lead: Neighbour Ivan Lomov, who came to propose, collapsed during a row over land and dogs (1). A brief mention of the later engagement (1).	1+1+1
17	Close neighbours often quarrel (1). Small issues can grow big (1). Friendship needs patience (1).	1+1+1
	OR: It starts with polite greeting (1). Tension rises through two quarrels (1). The climax is the faint followed by swift resolution (1).	1+1+1
18	Nervous, Lomov walked in dressed formally (1). The adjective phrase replaces a clause (1). Subject is the same (1).	1+1+1
	OR: She quickly returns when she learns of the proposal (1). She does not let pride block marriage for long (1). She sees advantage in the match (1).	1+1+1

SECTION — D (Long Answer) — Answers — 2 × 5 = 10

Q.	Expected Answer / Value Points	Marks
19	Tone: farce vs gentle realism (1). Characters (1). Themes of pride and growth (1). Humour (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Time: one afternoon (1). Place: Chubukov's house (1). Action: the proposal (1). Effects on pace (1). Conclusion (1).	2+2+1
20	Greeting and stand (1). Example from play (1). Reasoning (1). Counterpoint (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1
	OR: Format (1). Apology (1). Mention of the quarrel (1). Thanks and promises (1). Closing (1).	2+2+1

Mistakes to avoid:

- Writing that Lomov is a poor man; he is a **landowning neighbour** who comes to propose to Natalya Stepanovna but is soon distracted.
- Mixing up the quarrels: first **Oxen Meadows**, then the dogs **Guess** (Lomov's) and **Squeezer** (Chubukov's).
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